Preconception Care Visit

Planning for a healthy pregnancy starts before conception — here's what to expect and how we'll prepare together

❓ WHY PRECONCEPTION CARE MATTERS

- ✓ **Early Intervention:** Many supplements (like folic acid) are most effective when started BEFORE pregnancy
- ✓ **Identify Risks:** Catch and manage health conditions before they affect pregnancy
- ✓ **Lifestyle Adjustments:** Optimize diet, exercise, and eliminate harmful substances
- ✓ **Fertility Planning:** Understand your cycle and best timing for conception
- ✓ **Medication Safety:** Review all current medications for pregnancy compatibility
- ✓ **Vaccine Update:** Ensure immunizations are current before pregnancy

🩺 YOUR VISIT — WHAT WE'LL COVER

1. **Health Assessment**
   Medical history, surgeries, chronic conditions, family history, genetic risks, menstrual cycle review
2. **Lifestyle Evaluation**
   Diet and nutrition, exercise routine, substance use (alcohol, tobacco, drugs) — open conversation, no judgment
3. **Medication Review**
   Safety of current prescriptions during pregnancy; OTC supplements
4. **Risk Identification**
   Age-related fertility risks, environmental exposures, workplace safety
5. **Fertility Discussion**
   Conception planning, any fertility concerns, contraception if not yet ready

🔬 LAB TESTING CHECKLIST

General Health

- ✓ Complete Physical Exam
- ✓ Blood Pressure Check
- ✓ BMI & Weight Assessment

Blood Tests

- ✓ CBC · Blood Type & Rh Factor · Iron/Anemia
- ✓ Thyroid Function (TSH)
- ✓ Rubella & Varicella Immunity
- ✓ HIV · Hepatitis B & C · Syphilis
- ✓ Chlamydia & Gonorrhea

Genetic & Reproductive

- ✓ Genetic Carrier Screening (CF, sickle cell, etc.)
- ✓ Pap Smear (cervical health)
- ✓ Pelvic Ultrasound (if indicated)
- ✓ Hemoglobin A1C (diabetes risk)

Mental & Environmental

- ✓ Mental Health Screening
- ✓ Substance Use Screening
- ✓ Environmental Exposure Review

💉 VACCINES & NUTRITION

💉 Vaccines to Update BEFORE Pregnancy

- ✓ MMR (Measles, Mumps, Rubella)
- ✓ Varicella (chickenpox)
- ✓ HPV (if not completed)

⚠️ **Live vaccines (MMR, Varicella) should be given at least 4 weeks before conception**

🥗 Nutritional Priorities

- ✓ 🌿 **Folic acid 400–800mcg daily** — prevents neural tube defects
- ✓ 🐟 Omega-3 fatty acids for fetal brain development
- ✓ 🥛 Calcium & Vitamin D for bone health
- ✓ 🫘 Iron — especially if anemic or vegetarian
- ✓ 🧬 Prenatal vitamin — start now, before conceiving

The Best Gift You Can Give Your Future Baby

Starting preconception care 3–6 months before you want to conceive gives you the best chance of a healthy pregnancy. Small changes now — taking folic acid, stopping smoking, managing chronic conditions — can make a significant difference in pregnancy outcomes. We are honored to be part of your journey to parenthood. 💚